



Office of  
Deputy Commissioner  
of Maritime Affairs

## THE REPUBLIC OF LIBERIA LIBERIA MARITIME AUTHORITY

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### TECHNICAL LETTER 2021-01 03 December 2021

#### Supersedes Technical Letter 2018-2

#### **Subject: Underwater Inspection of the Bottom in Lieu of Drydock (UWILD) and Extension of Bottom, Renewal, and Special Surveys for MODUs**

This technical letter provides guidance on and authorizes the class societies recognized by the Liberian Administration to carry out MODU UWILD and authorization to extend MODU bottom, renewal and special surveys for up to three (3) months, without prior permission from the Administration,

1. UWILD - class societies recognized by the Liberian Administration to carry out MODU surveys are hereby authorized to carry out UWILD, without prior permission from the Administration subject to the following conditions:

- a. If no flag state control action, PSC action, casualty, or pollution incident is associated with the bottom survey.
- b. The Administration shall be notified when a UWILD is scheduled prior to the commencement of the inspection.
- c. The UWILD shall be planned and carried out in accordance with all applicable class society rules and requirements.
- d. Any major deficiencies, or failure of the unit to complete the UWILD, or surveyor/class society rejection of the UWILD shall be immediately reported to the Administration
- e. The Administration shall be notified when the UWILD has been completed and credited. The complete report and surveyor's comments shall be made available to the Administration via the class societies database. Upon request the class society shall provide the Administration copy of the video recorded during the UWILD.

2. Extension of MODU bottom surveys - The bottom survey, both out of water and UWILD, may be extended for up to 3 months without prior permission from the Administration subject to the following conditions:

- a. The unit has no major outstanding Conditions of Class (CoC) or other deficiencies or compliance items scheduled to be rectified during the bottom survey
- b. No flag state control action, PSC action, casualty, or pollution incident is associated with the bottom survey.
- c. Prior approval from the Administration must be obtained if any of these conditions exist.
- d. Any extension of a bottom survey longer than 3 months or any subsequent extension of the same survey will require prior permission from the Administration

3. Extension of MODU special and renewal surveys - The special and renewal surveys may be extended for up to three months without prior permission from the Administration if exploration, exploitation, or offshore activity operational circumstances prevent the survey from being carried out by its due date. Such extension of a special/renewal survey without obtaining prior approval from the Administration shall be contingent upon:

- a. The unit having no major outstanding CoC or other deficiencies or compliance items scheduled to be rectified during the renewal/special survey
- b. No flag state control, PSC action, casualty, or pollution incident involved with the extension.
- c. Prior approval from the Administration would have to be obtain if any of these conditions exist
- d. An occasional survey and other surveys deemed necessary by the class society shall be carried out prior to granting the extension. However, if the class society determines that circumstances or the condition of the unit justifies extending the surveys administratively without the attendance by a class surveyor, the extension may be granted administratively

Extensions of special and renewal surveys for reasons other than the operational circumstances listed above will require prior approval from the Administration.

Any extension of a special or renewal survey longer than three months or any subsequent extension of the same survey will require prior permission from the Administration.

Any extension of the annual and/or periodic servicing of survival craft and/or fire and safety equipment will require the issuance of a dispensation by the Administration.

The Administration shall be notified whenever any survey is extended

If you have any questions on this Technical Letter please contact this office at [regsandstandards@liscr.com](mailto:regsandstandards@liscr.com).

Regards;

*Anthony Dupree Jr.*

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**TECHNICAL LETTER 2021-02**  
**03 December 2021**

**Subject: Survey and Certification of MODUS and MOUs**

This technical letter provides guidance on procedures and requirements of survey and certification of Liberian flagged MODUs and MOUs.

**DEFINITIONS:**

Mobile Offshore Drilling Unit (MODU) - a vessel capable of engaging in drilling operations for the exploration or exploitation of resources beneath the seabed.

Mobile Offshore Unit - a vessel which can be readily relocated and which can perform an industrial function involving offshore operations or activities such as:

- Construction
- Maintenance (including the maintenance of wells)
- Lifting operations
- Pipe-laying and related operations
- Seabed mining operations
- Emergency/contingency preparedness, including firefighting
- Production systems
- Storage systems
- Electrical power generating system
- Accommodations

National MODU Safety Certificate - a certificate issued by the Administration or RO on behalf of the Administration, to an MODU that meets the requirements for MODUs contained in Liberian MOU Standards (RLM-293).

National MOU Safety Certificate - a certificate issued by the Administration or RO on behalf of the Administration, to an MOU that meets the requirements for MOUs contained in Liberian MOU Standards (RLM-293).

**SURVEY:**

All units are required to be classed as a mobile offshore drilling unit or mobile offshore unit or, subject to agreement by the Administration, equivalent classification as assigned by the class society.

In addition to meeting the applicable class requirements, each MODU shall be surveyed for compliance with the provisions of the applicable MODU Code and the Administration's MOU Standards (RLM 293), as applicable.

In addition to meeting the applicable class requirements, each MOU shall be surveyed for compliance with the provisions of the Administration's MOU Standards (RLM 293) and

- a. 1989 MODU Code for units built prior to 1 January 2012
- b. 2009 MODU Code for units built on or after 1 January 2012

The survey schedule for each MOU shall be as specified in the applicable MODU Code unless a different survey interval has been agreed to by the Administration.

## **CERTIFICATION**

1. Each MODU, upon successful completion of the applicable surveys, shall be issued the applicable MODU Code Safety Certificate or National MODU Safety Certificate as applicable. All exemptions granted to the unit shall be noted on the Certificate or an attached sheet.

The MODU Code Safety Certificate will be valid for five (5) years, running concurrently with the five (5) year classification survey period.

2. Each MOU, upon successful completion of the applicable surveys, shall be issued a Liberian National MOU Safety Certificate

The MOU Safety Certificate will be valid for five (5) years, running concurrently with the five (5) year classification survey period.

3. All units shall be issued an IOPP, IAPP, and ISPP Certificate in accordance with the applicable provisions of MARPOL 73/78, as amended.

4. In accordance with the applicable provisions of the ICLL 66, all units shall be issued an International Load Line Certificate.

5. All units shall be issued a Safety Radio Certificate in accordance with the provisions of SOLAS Chapter IV. In addition, all units must obtain a Radio Station License issued by the Administration. The requirements for obtaining a Ship Radio Station License can be found in Liberian Marine Notices RAD-001 and RAD-002.

6. If the coastal state in whose waters the unit is located requires compliance with the Special Purpose Ship (SPS) Code or the owner/operators wish to obtain an ISPS Code certificate they should be informed to contact the Administration.

7. MLC 2006 - The Liberian Administration has decided not to apply the provisions of MLC, 2006 to MODUs and MOUs whose primary service is drilling or mining operations for the

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exploration, exploitation, and production of resources beneath the sea-bed; servicing or construction of offshore facilities; storage and processing of crude oil and other gas and petroleum products; generation of electrical power for use ashore; and are not normally engaged in navigation or international voyages. However, if MODU or MOU owners/operators wish to apply MLC on a voluntary basis, they should be informed to contact the Administration.

8. In accordance with the provisions of SOLAS Chapter IX Self-Propelled MODUs and MOUs of 500 gross tons and over engaged in international voyages are subject to the ISM Code in accordance with Regulation 2.1.3 in Chapter IX of SOLAS. Such units should be informed to contact the Administration regarding issuance of the appropriate ISM certificates.

10. In accordance with the provisions of SOLAS Chapter XI-2, Self-Propelled MODUs and MOUs of 500 gross tons and over engaged in international voyages are subject to the ISPS Code in accordance with Regulation 1.1.1.3 in Chapter XI-2 of SOLAS. Such units should be informed to contact the Administration regarding issuance of the appropriate ISM certificates

11. MODUs and MOUs on location are not required to be certified for compliance with the requirements of the ISM Code or the ISPS Code. However, if the coastal state in whose waters the unit is located requires compliance with the ISM Code and/or the ISPS Code, or the owners /operators wish to voluntarily comply with ISM and/or ISPS Code they should be informed to contact the Administration.

12. Depending on the unit's operation and/or coastal state requirements the MODU/MOUs may have to comply with other International rules and regulations (BWM, Anti-fouling, etc.)

If you have any questions on this Technical Letter please contact [regsandstandards@lisr.com](mailto:regsandstandards@lisr.com).

Regards;

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